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Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 1

Semester 2

Terms 3 and 4

20 single-page puzzles
Almost every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

This booklet belongs to

_____

[Publisher line: wording to be confirmed by the owner]

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Teacher notes (DRAFT)

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What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 1 pupils who finish their work early. This is Semester 2 of two booklets (Terms 3 and 4). Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Which terms

The pages are grouped by the order in which Primary 1 topics are typically taught: this booklet follows Terms 3 and 4, the other booklet follows Semester 1 (Terms 1 and 2). Schools vary, so check your scheme of work: use a page whenever its topic has been taught, from either booklet.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (10 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (10 pages).

How the pages check themselves

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer, and it asks the pupil to see whether the answer makes sense. On the Measure and Draw page the check tests reading the ruler and finding the end mark; look at the line the pupil draws at a glance.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word.
- **Colour by code.** Each answer is found in a key of five numbers and the part is coloured with that crayon. The pupil counts the parts of each colour and compares with the box on the page; matching parts must share a colour.
- **Route.** The line must reach FINISH through the stated number of boxes, and every box on it must follow the rule on the page.
- **Total.** The whole count must make the total printed in the strip (the graph pages add a second sum).

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

How the checks were tested

A script tried every single wrong answer and every wrong arrangement on every page. Each check rejected at least 95% of them. A wrong answer that spells any of about 129 000 English words counts as not rejected. Two wrong answers at once were not all tested.

Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes; the colour-by-code pages (S2-03) take longer because pupils colour a picture. Pupils need their own crayons (five colours: yellow, red, blue, green, orange). For a pencil-only copy the pupil writes Y, R, B, G or O in each part; the tally and the matching parts are checked the same way. Light crayons work best: a dark crayon hides the number in the part on a photocopy.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **Problem solving.** Some pages (S2-02, S2-11, S2-12, S2-13, S2-20) practise the kinds of question that appear in school tests, such as stories with more than one step, fewest coins, choosing two things for an exact price and printed facts, rather than one numbered syllabus outcome. The key tags them problem solving.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Each page is one side only. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large for young hands. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size); on the ruler pages a real ruler matches the drawn ruler only at 100%.

Contents: Semester 2

Page	Code	Puzzle	Tier
S2-01	P1-03	Fair Shares	1 star
S2-02	P1-39	Share and Group	1 star
S2-03	P1-14	Colour the Ice Cream	2 stars
S2-04	P1-05	Times Code	2 stars
S2-05	P1-40	True or False	2 stars
S2-06	P1-11	Big Number Sums	2 stars
S2-07	P1-23	Stack It Up	1 star
S2-08	P1-32	Measure and Draw	1 star
S2-09	P1-06	What Time Is It?	1 star
S2-10	P1-15	Coin Purses	1 star
S2-11	P1-28	Fewest Coins	1 star
S2-12	P1-16	Shop Prices	2 stars
S2-13	P1-27	Which Two Items?	2 stars
S2-14	P1-18	Clock Time	2 stars
S2-15	P1-30	Morning or Evening?	1 star
S2-16	P1-29	How Long Does It Last?	1 star
S2-17	P1-35	Read the Picture Graph	1 star
S2-18	P1-20	Fruit Graph	2 stars
S2-19	P1-36	Graph Detective Two	2 stars
S2-20	P1-22	Two-Step Stories	2 stars

Pages are independent. The footer code shows the page in this booklet and, in brackets, its number in the full set of 40 (P1-01 to P1-40).

What the booklet covers

Whole Numbers 1.6 patterns in number sequences **S2-03**

Addition and Subtraction 2.1 concepts of addition and subtraction **S2-20**

Addition and Subtraction 2.2 use of +, - and = **S2-20**

Addition and Subtraction 2.5 adding and subtracting within 100 **S2-06, S2-07, S2-13, S2-20**

Addition and Subtraction 2.6 adding and subtracting using algorithms **S2-07**

Addition and Subtraction 2.7 mental calculation involving addition and subtraction (within 20; 2-digit number and ones without renaming; 2-digit number and tens) **S2-06, S2-12, S2-20**

Multiplication and Division 3.1 concepts of multiplication and division **S2-01, S2-02, S2-04, S2-05**

Multiplication and Division 3.2 use of x **S2-04, S2-05**

Multiplication and Division 3.3 multiplying within 40 **S2-04, S2-05**

Multiplication and Division 3.4 dividing within 20 **S2-01, S2-02**

Money 1.1 counting amount of money (in cents up to $1; in dollars up to $100) **S2-10, S2-11, S2-12, S2-13**

Length 1.1 measuring length in centimetres **S2-08**

Length 1.2 use of abbreviation cm **S2-08**

Length 1.4 measuring and drawing a line segment to the nearest cm **S2-08**

Time 2.1 telling time to 5 minutes **S2-09, S2-14, S2-15, S2-16**

Time 2.2 use of 'am' and 'pm' **S2-15**

Time 2.3 use of abbreviations h and min **S2-16**

Time 2.4 duration of one hour/half hour **S2-14, S2-16**

Picture Graphs 1.1 reading and interpreting data from picture graphs **S2-17, S2-18, S2-19**

Outcomes practised in the other booklet: Whole Numbers 1.1; Whole Numbers 1.2; Whole Numbers 1.3; Whole Numbers 1.4; Whole Numbers 1.5; Whole Numbers 1.7; Addition and Subtraction 2.3; Addition and Subtraction 2.4; Length 1.3; 2D Shapes 1.1; 2D Shapes 1.2; 2D Shapes 1.3; 2D Shapes 1.4.

S2-01 (P1-03)

Fair Shares

Name _____

Topic: Sharing equally and making equal groups (within 20)

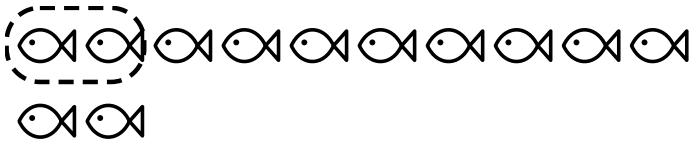
Look at the pictures.
Write how many.
Use the code table.

Share equally: each plate, box, bowl or bag gets the same.

Share 14 stars equally among 2 boxes. How many on each box?

1 

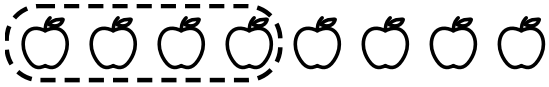
Put 12 fish in groups of 2. How many groups?

2 

Share 9 balloons equally among 3 bags. How many on each bag?

3 

Put 8 apples in groups of 4. How many groups?

4 

Share 8 stars equally among 2 boxes. How many on each box?

5 

Put 10 balloons in groups of 2. How many groups?

6 

Code table

1 = G	2 = D	3 = A	4 = O	5 = W	6 = H	7 = S	8 = L	9 = M

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S2-02 (P1-39)

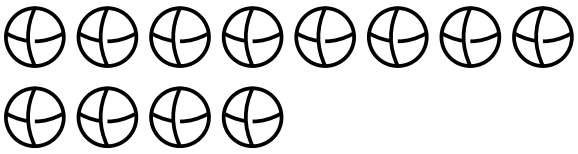
Share and Group

★ Name _____

Topic: Sharing and grouping stories within 20, and printed facts

Read each story.
The sharer gets a share too.
Write how many. Use the code table.

1 Mei and 3 friends share 12 balls equally. How many does each child get? ☐



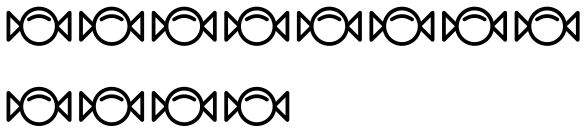
2 Fact: 1 bird has 2 legs. Lily counts 16 legs. How many birds? ☐



3 8 kites go in groups of 2. How many groups? ☐



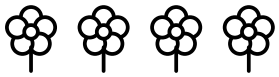
4 Ravi has 12 sweets. Ravi shares them equally with 1 friend. How many does each child get? ☐



5 Fact: 1 car has 4 wheels. Jenny counts 20 wheels. How many cars? ☐



6 4 flowers are shared equally among 2 plates. How many on each plate? ☐



Code table

1 = K	2 = E	3 = S	4 = O	5 = G	6 = N	7 = J	8 = P

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-03 (P1-14)

Colour the Ice Cream

★★ Name _____

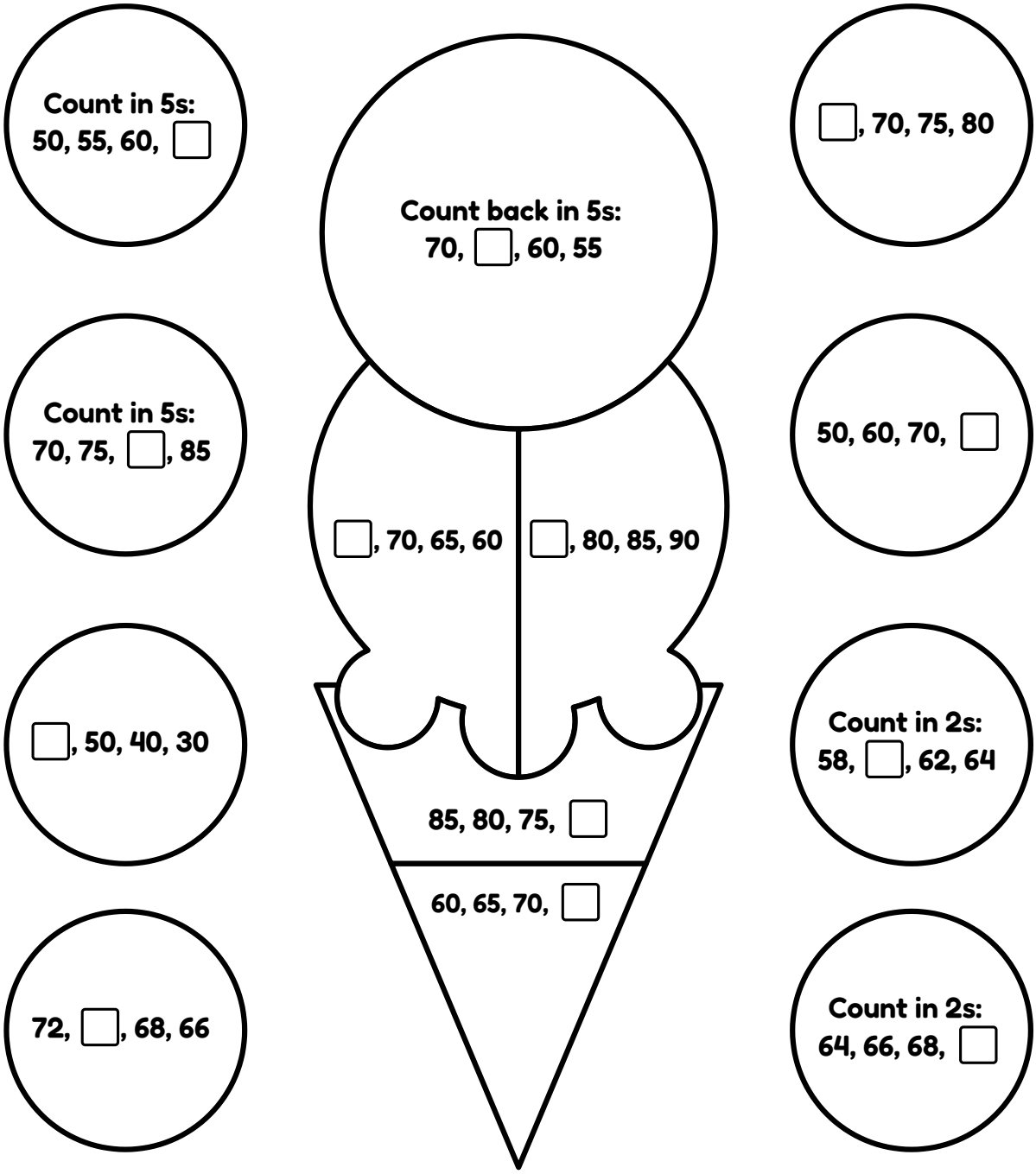
Topic: Counting in 2s, 5s and 10s

Find the missing number in each pattern.

Find it in the key.

Colour the part. No crayon? Write Y, R, B, G or O.

60	65	70	75	80
yellow	red	blue	green	orange



Check it.
Count the parts of each colour. You should have: yellow 2, red 3, blue 3, green 3, orange 2.
Parts in the same place on the left and on the right have the same colour.

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S2-04 (P1-05)

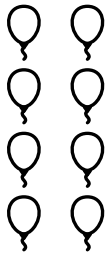
Times Code

★★ Name _____

Topic: Multiplication within 40: groups of, and the missing number

3 × 4 means 3 groups of 4.
Find the missing numbers.
Use the code table.

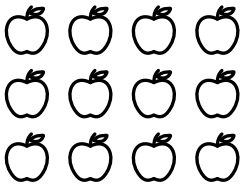
1 ☐ × 2 = 8



2 3 × 5 = ☐



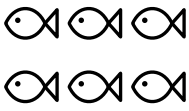
3 3 groups of 4 = ☐



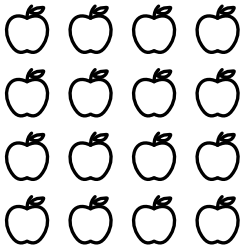
4 3 × ☐ = 6



5 2 groups of 3 = ☐



6 4 × 4 = ☐



Code table

1 = B	2 = A	4 = S	6 = R	12 = U	15 = Q	16 = E	17 = V

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-05 (P1-40)

True or False

★★ Name _____

Topic: Multiplication and sharing: true or false statements

Is each sentence true or false?
Tick T or F in each row.
Write the ticked letters.

1	6 groups of 2 is 8.	☐ T (B)	☐ F (T)
2	6 in groups of 2 makes 4 groups.	☐ T (W)	☐ F (E)
3	12 in groups of 3 makes 4 groups.	☐ T (A)	☐ F (M)
4	6 groups of 2 is 10.	☐ T (R)	☐ F (C)
5	8 shared by 2 children is 4 each.	☐ T (U)	☐ F (K)
6	6 × 5 = 30.	☐ T (P)	☐ F (F)

Check it. Write the ticked letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-06 (P1-11)

Big Number Sums

★★ Name _____

Topic: Add and subtract within 100

Find the missing numbers.
Use the code table.

① 31 – 10 = ☐

② 84 – 3 = ☐

③ 54 + 40 = ☐

④ 67 – ☐ = 37

⑤ ☐ + 40 = 57

⑥ 81 + 7 = ☐

Code table

15 = X	17 = L	21 = F	30 = I	41 = N	68 = K
81 = A	82 = V	88 = Y	94 = M	95 = Z	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-07 (P1-23)

Stack It Up

★ Name _____

Topic: Adding and subtracting tens and ones, written in boxes (within 100)

Add or take away.
Write tens and ones in the boxes.
Use the code table.

1

$$\begin{array}{r} 6\ 4 \\ -\ 3\ 2 \\ \hline \square\ \square \end{array}$$

tens ones

2

$$\begin{array}{r} 2\ 1 \\ +\ 4\ 4 \\ \hline \square\ \square \end{array}$$

tens ones

3

$$\begin{array}{r} 5\ \square \\ +\ 1\ 3 \\ \hline 6\ 9 \end{array}$$

tens ones

4

$$\begin{array}{r} 7\ 5 \\ -\ 3\ 5 \\ \hline \square\ \square \end{array}$$

tens ones

5

$$\begin{array}{r} 8\ \square \\ -\ 3\ 9 \\ \hline 5\ 0 \end{array}$$

tens ones

6

$$\begin{array}{r} 3\ 5 \\ +\ 1\ 3 \\ \hline \square\ \square \end{array}$$

tens ones

Code table

6 = N	9 = E	10 = A	16 = Q	32 = D	40 = K
46 = B	48 = Y	63 = V	65 = O	66 = X	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-08 (P1-32)

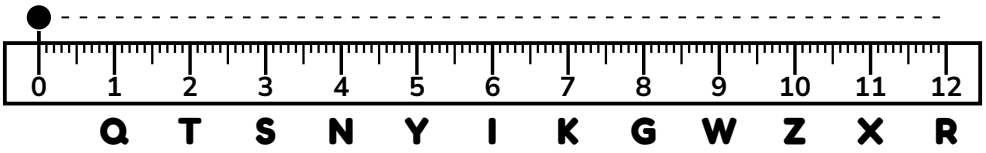
Measure and Draw

Name _____

Topic: Length in cm: measure a bar and draw a line

Measure the bars in cm.
Draw the lines from the dots.
Use the code ruler.

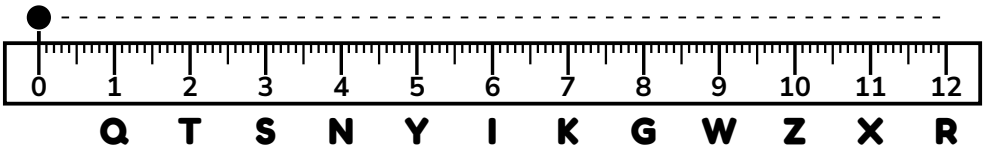
1



Draw 3 cm

letter

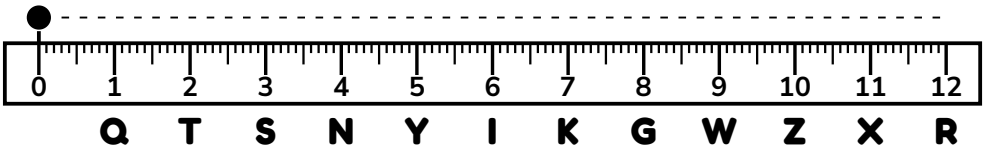
2



Draw 2 cm

letter

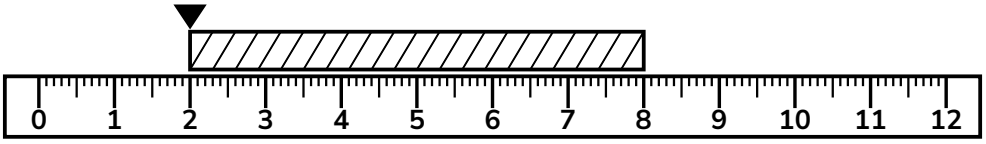
3



Draw 12 cm

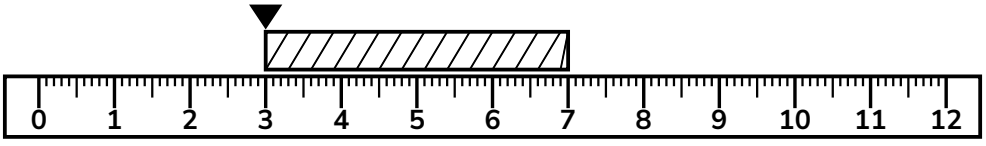
letter

4



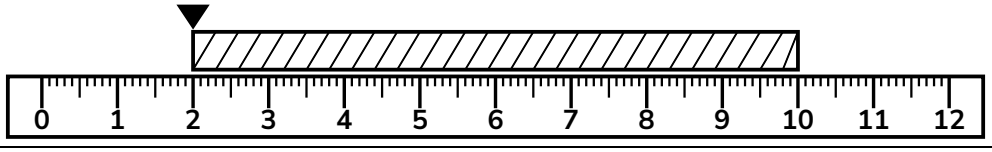
cm letter

5



cm letter

6



cm letter

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Q	T	S	N	Y	I	K	G	W	Z	X	R

Check it. Write the letters in order.
Do they spell a word?

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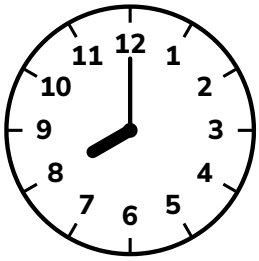
S2-09 (P1-06)

What Time Is It?

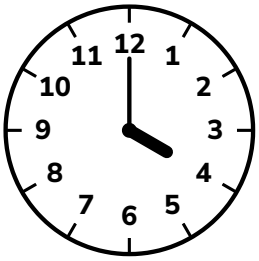
Name _____

Topic: Time: o'clock and half past

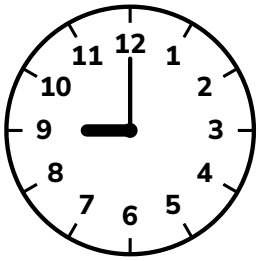
Read each clock.
Write the time in the boxes.
Use the code table.

1 

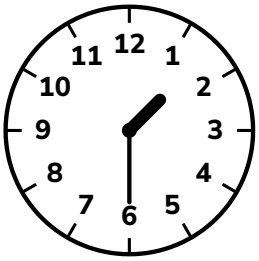
What is the time? ☐ : ☐

2 

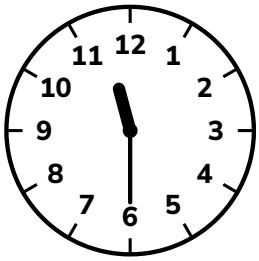
What is the time? ☐ : ☐

3 

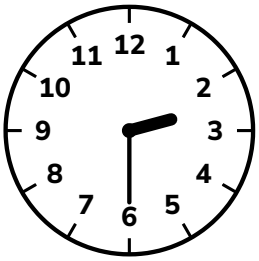
What is the time? ☐ : ☐

4 

What is the time? ☐ : ☐

5 

What is the time? ☐ : ☐

6 

What is the time? ☐ : ☐

Code table

11:30 = N	9:00 = C	4:00 = E	1:00 = X	8:00 = S
3:00 = Q	4:30 = R	1:30 = O	2:30 = D	5:00 = B

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-10 (P1-15)

Coin Purses

★ Name _____

Topic: Money: counting coins in cents (up to $1)

Add the coins in each purse.
Write the total in cents.
Use the code table.

1. 

¢

2. 

¢

3. 

¢

4. 

¢

5. 

¢

Code table

15 = Z	25 = N	40 = A	45 = Q	60 = I	75 = C
80 = P	85 = X	95 = O	100 = W		

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-11 (P1-28)

Fewest Coins

★ Name _____

Topic: Money: counting coins in cents; fewest coins and ways to pay

Look at the coins.
Write how many.
Use the code table.

Coins: 

1. Pay 70¢ with the fewest coins. How many coins? ☐

2. Pay 35¢ with the fewest coins. How many coins? ☐

3. How many 5¢ coins make 45¢? 

☐

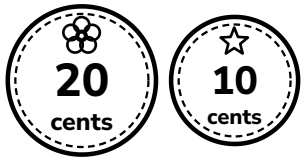
4. How many 10¢ coins make 40¢? 

☐

5. Tick each purse that holds exactly 30¢. How many ticks? ☐



☐



☐



☐



☐

Code table

1 = P	2 = S	3 = T	4 = M	5 = Y	9 = A	10 = X	12 = J

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-12 (P1-16)

Shop Prices

★★ Name _____

Topic: Money: dollars, more and less

Read the clues.
Use the grid to cross and tick.
Write each price, then its letter.

The prices are:

$5 O	$7 E	$8 Z	$12 F	$15 R

- The kite costs $3 more than the ball.
- The book costs more than the pen.
- The pen costs more than the cup.
- The pen costs more than the ball.

How to use the grid

	5	9
Zed	✓	×
Yan	×	

Clue: Zed has 5.
Tick Zed under 5.
Cross out the rest of that line across and down.

	$5	$7	$8	$12	$15
pen					
book					
ball					
kite					
cup					

	price	letter
pen		
book		
ball		
kite		
cup		

The ball and the pen cost $ ____ together. Code letter ____

Code table

$7 = X	$15 = J	$17 = N	$18 = Q

Check it. Read your six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S2-13 (P1-27)

Which Two Items?

★★ Name _____

Topic: Money in dollars: which two things cost exactly the amount paid

Each person buys 2 things.
Find which 2 things.
Write their letters, cheaper first.

The shop sells 6 things.

 **cup** **$8** (G)	 **boat** **$24** (N)	 **ball** **$16** (E)
 **kite** **$13** (A)	 **drum** **$18** (T)	 **toy car** **$9** (M)

(1) Jenny pays $22 for 2 things. $ ☐ + $ ☐ **letters** ☐ ☐

(2) Aisha pays $32 for 2 things. $ ☐ + $ ☐ **letters** ☐ ☐

(3) Lily pays $34 for 2 things. $ ☐ + $ ☐ **letters** ☐ ☐

Check it. Read your six letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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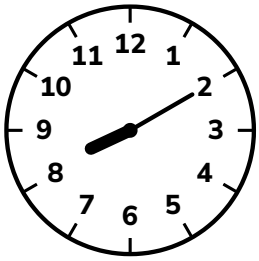
S2-14 (P1-18)

Clock Time

★★ Name _____

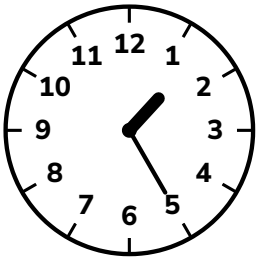
Topic: Time to 5 minutes: 1 hour and half an hour later

Read each clock.
Find the time later.
Write it in the boxes.

1 

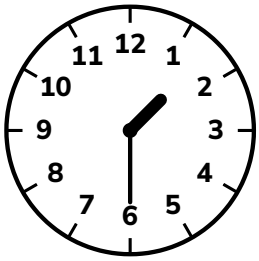
What is the time **1 hour later**?

☐ : ☐

2 

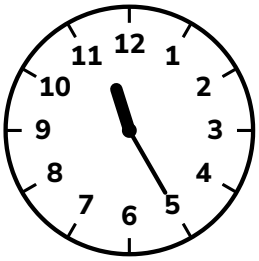
What is the time **half an hour later**?

☐ : ☐

3 

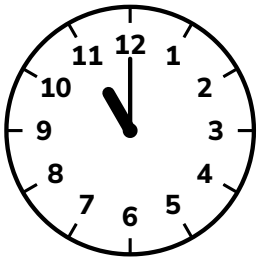
What is the time **1 hour later**?

☐ : ☐

4 

What is the time **half an hour later**?

☐ : ☐

5 

What is the time **1 hour later**?

☐ : ☐

Code table

2:30 = I	12:55 = Y	9:10 = C	6:05 = P	10:10 = K
12:00 = B	1:55 = L	5:05 = Q	11:55 = M	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-15 (P1-30)

Morning or Evening?

★ Name _____

Topic: Time: am and pm with times to 5 minutes

Start at START.
Step only on boxes that make sense.
Move up, down, left or right.

8:00 pm dinner	**9:00 am** breakfast	**8:00 am** school starts	**4:00 pm** play outside
START **9:00 pm** bedtime	**7:00 am** lunch	**8:00 am** dinner	**7:00 am** wake up
8:00 pm bedtime	**9:00 pm** breakfast	**6:30 am** breakfast	**7:30 am** wake up
1:00 am lunch	**6:30 pm** breakfast	**7:00 pm** wake up	FINISH **5:00 pm** play outside

Check it. Does your line reach FINISH? Count its boxes: are there 8? Does each box make sense?

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S2-16 (P1-29)

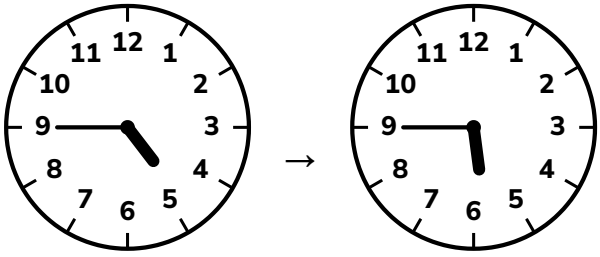
How Long Does It Last? ★

Name _____

Topic: Time: how long a thing lasts (1 h or 30 min) and when it ends

Read the clocks and the table.
Write 1 h, 30 min or a time.
Use the code table.

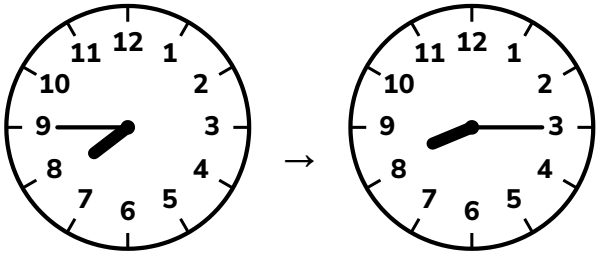
1 **How long does it last?**



start → end

It lasts _____

2 **How long does it last?**



start → end

It lasts _____

	Show	Starts	Ends	Lasts
3	Magic	11:15		1 h
4	Music		2:35	30 min
5	Puppets	7:45		30 min
6	Film		1:10	1 h

Code table

1 h = S	10:15 = J	12:10 = R	12:15 = I	12:20 = V
12:40 = X	2:05 = L	30 min = A	3:05 = C	8:15 = O

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? _____

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S2-17 (P1-35)

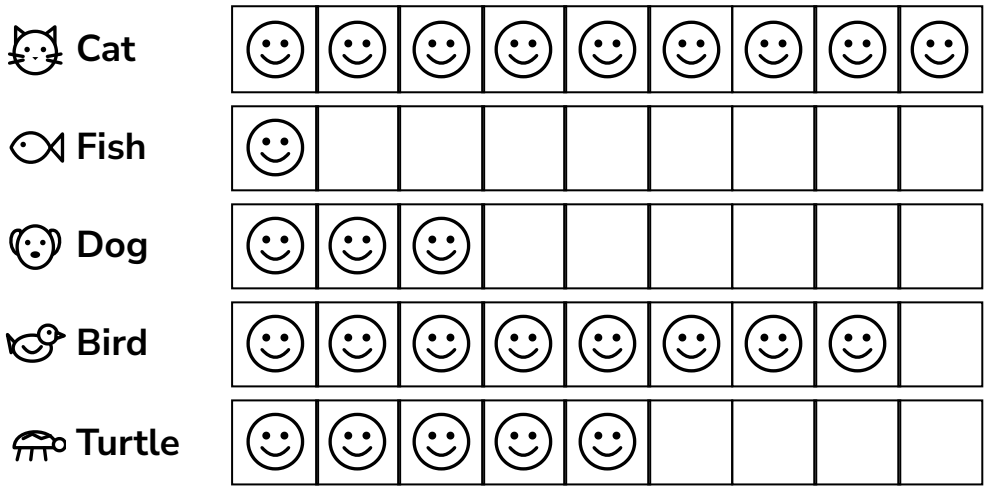
Read the Picture Graph ★

Name _____

Topic: Picture graphs: read the graph and answer questions

Look at the picture graph.
Answer each question.
Use the code table.

Children chose a pet. ☺ = 1 child.



1	Which pet got the most votes?	2	Which pet got the fewest votes?
3	How many children chose Turtle?	4	How many chose Fish and Bird in all?
5	How many more chose Cat than Dog?	6	How many children chose in all?

Code table

4 = B	5 = R	6 = E	7 = X	9 = K	25 = C
26 = Y	Cat = T	Dog = P	Fish = U		

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-18 (P1-20)

Fruit Graph

★★ Name _____

Topic: Picture graphs: read, complete and answer

Two rows are done.
Draw one face for each child.
Use the clues. Answer a and b.

Children chose a fruit. ☺ = 1 child. Draw a face or a circle.

Apple	☺	☺	☺	☺	☺				
Banana	☺	☺	☺	☺					
Orange									
Grape									
Pear									

- Orange has 4 more than Apple.
- Grape has 2 more than Banana.
- Pear has 1 fewer than Banana.

a) Most children chose [ ].

b) **Apple** has [ ] more than **Pear**.

Check it.
Count all the faces. Is the total 27?
Add the faces in your a) row to your b) answer. Is the sum 11?

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S2-19 (P1-36)

Graph Detective Two ★★

Name _____

Topic: Picture graphs: read, complete and answer from clues

Two rows are done.
Draw one star for each child.
Use the clues. Answer a and b.

Children chose a toy. ☆ = 1 child. Draw a star.

Car	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆				
Boat	☆	☆	☆	☆					
Drum									
Cup									
Kite									

- Drum has the same as Car.
- Cup and Boat have 7 in all.
- Kite has 3 more than Cup.

a) Most children chose ☐.

b) **Car** has ☐ more than **Cup**.

Check it.
Count all the stars. Is the total 23?
Add the stars in your a) row to your b) answer. Is the sum 8?

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S2-20 (P1-22)

Two-Step Stories

★★ Name _____

Topic: Two-step stories: add, take away, work backwards

Read each story.
Write the answer to each step.
Use the code table.

1 Aisha had some stickers.
Aisha gave away 10.
Now Aisha has 33.
Then Aisha gets 2 more.

at first ☐ at the end ☐

2 Lily has 10 apples.
Lily picks 6 more.
Then Lily eats 2.

step 1 ☐ step 2 ☐

3 Ben has 9 sweets.
Ben eats 5.
Then Ben gets 3 more.

step 1 ☐ step 2 ☐

4 Ravi had some stars.
Ravi gave away 5.
Now Ravi has 9.
Then Ravi gets 4 more.

at first ☐ at the end ☐

5 Jenny has 55 stickers.
Jenny gets 30 more.
Then Jenny gives away 2.

step 1 ☐ step 2 ☐

6 Fact: 1 tricycle has 3 wheels.
Mei sees 4 tricycles.
3 wheels are broken.

all the wheels ☐ wheels that work ☐

Code table

3 = P	7 = I	9 = R	13 = T	14 = U	24 = Q
25 = X	34 = J	35 = G	37 = Z	83 = A	

Check it. Write the letters in order.
Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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